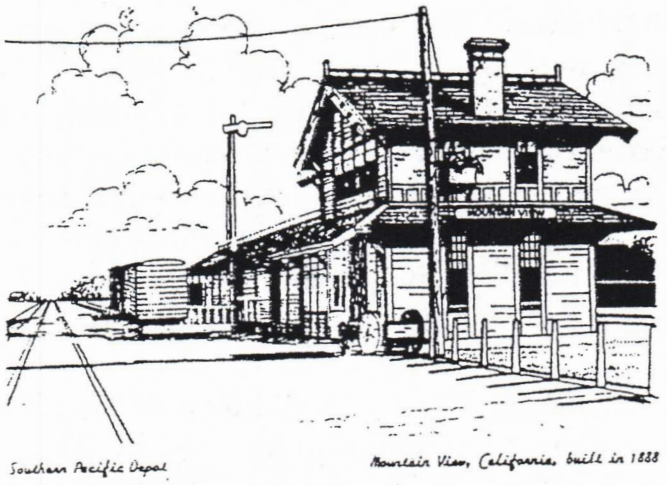
Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042
Trudi Tuban - Editor



THE EL CAMINO REAL MISSION BELLS PRESENTED BY JOHN KOLSTAD SUNDAY, MAY 4, 2008 AT 2PM

INTRODUCTION--BY HONOR SPITZ

We are indeed fortunate to have John Kolstad as our guest speaker for the May 4th meeting. John is the owner of the California Bell Company, a local enterprise that is responsible for the manufacturing and placement of the replica Mission bells seen along the El Camino Real from Los Angeles to San Francisco. Please join us for what promises to be a most enjoyable and educational presentation. Refreshments and good conversation will be "served" after John's talk.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE--BY ROBERT WEAVER

Part of growing an organization is coalition building. Reaching out to other groups that share common interests and goals is a great way to share information and attract new members. Over the past year, the Mountain View Historical Association has successfully established connections with the Friends of "R" House and the Los Altos History Museum. As these relationships strengthen, we are continuing our outreach to other groups in the area.

One of my goals as president is to provide the membership with meetings that offer more than just a social event. Former Program chair Wallace Erichsen, and current

chair Honor Spitz, have done a wonderful job of providing informative and stimulating programs for our members. Our May meeting upholds that standard and takes it one step further. We have invited all the 4th grade teachers in Mountain View to attend our May meeting on the "El Camino Bells". The 4th grade is when students learn about California History, and the "El Camino Bells" are symbolic of the Mission Trail. Our ultimate goal is to establish a program with the schools, where the 4th grade students raise funds toward the purchase of a bell. At the base of that bell will be a plaque acknowledging the efforts of the 4th graders of Mountain View. It is our hope that this will instill in every student a strong sense of place and the feeling of being a stakeholder in the community.

The History Museum / Education Center is moving ahead. We have a crucial City Council meeting on Monday, April 21 at 6:00 P.M. to have the Cuesta Annex Master Plan adopted for the 2008/2009 Council Goals. Our Museum Steering Committee has put together a very strong proposal, and once the specific siting has been confirmed we will begin our Capital Campaign.

I look forward to seeing you at the May meeting.

SPECIAL BOOK SIGNING AT THE MEETING

Ginny Kaminski, author of "Henry Rengstorff and His Family," will be at the meeting and available for book signing. The books are $5 each.

OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS--COMPILED BY BARBARA KINCHEN

100 Years Ago (1908): Mountain View Skating Rink (roller skates) reopened under management of Professor E.E. Kitching, a champion skater. The Mountain View Brass Band provides the music.

The old winery on the Distel place (El Camino Real) has been converted into a summer school for convent girls.

The salary for the Postmaster has been raised from $2,200 to $2,300 per year.

George Spicer, retired merchant now living on Villa Street, is raising pigeons for recreation and profit.

75 Years Ago (1933): **The USS Akron, the dirigible which visited here a year ago, went down in a storm off the coast of New Jersey on April 4, 1933 with only three survivors. Over 70 perished, including Rear Admiral William A. Moffett, Chief of the Navy Bureau of Aeronautics.**

Over 5,000 attended the formal commissioning ceremonies on April 12, 1933 for the US Naval Air Station Sunnyvale at Mountain View, now 80% completed.

Adult admission is 25 cents at Blanco's Mountain View Theatre on Castro Street.

The new 3.2 beer cannot be sold within the city limits of Mountain View. In 1912, the town adopted the local option law banning liquor sales.

50 YEARS AGO (1957): **Dedication ceremonies were held for Holy Cross High School at 1030 McKelvey Drive (now Miramonte).**

Sylvania Electrical Products needing extra space while expanding its Evelyn-Whisman site, has leased two buildings: Number 301 Castro Street, which was occupied by Bank of America from 1946 to 1955 and a warehouse in the 100 block of Calderon.

At the suggestion of the Historical Association, an elementary school, to be constructed on Ortego, will be named in honor of Miss Victorine Klein, teacher in local schools from 1902 to 1934.

Ad for Lucky Stores: Tomato Soup, 10 oz can... 10 cents; Corned Beef Hash, 16 oz can... 39 cents; Salad Oil, 1 quart... 59 cents; Pork Chops, center cut... 98 cents per pound.

25 YEARS AGO (1982): **Description of the bandit who robbed the Quick Stop Market, 161 West Evelyn, at midnight: black man in his 20's, 5 feet 7 inches tall, clean shaven, full makeup, shoulder length black wig, wearing a full length red plaid coat with fur trim.**

Malcolm "Max" Darroch Aitken, science teacher at Mountain View Union High School from 1928 to 1958, died in Pacific Grove at age 88. As a young man, he lived at Mt. Hamilton where his father was the director.

The Portuguese IFES Society on Stierlin Road expects over 1,000 people to attend on Memorial Day for the last "bloodless" bullfight. While California law prohibits bullfights, an exception can be made when they are a part of religious observances. The arena will be turned into a parking lot.

Guest of honor at the Navy's celebration for Moffett Field's 50th birthday was Retired Rear Admiral W. E. Moffett, Jr., son of the station's namesake.

A large stone monument, supporting a huge anchor, commemorates those lost in the crash of the dirigible USS Shenandoah in 1925, has been installed and now marks the area as Shenandoah Plaza at Moffett Field.

STREET TALK--BY BARBARA KINCHEN

Am I correct in assuming that the three short Los Altos streets named Eastwood Court, Eastwood Drive and Eastwood Place, all near the intersection of Miramonte and Covington, are named for the Joseph Eastwood family whose home was on Miramonte where St. Francis High School is?

NEW TO THE MOUNTAIN VIEW LIBRARY'S HISTORY CENTER--BY BARBARA KINCHEN

From Mrs. Margaret Sideroff (nee Garliepp): A beautifully framed 8" by 40" photograph of Highway Grammar School of pupils and teachers in 1937, Margaret's graduation year.

From member Kevin Duggan: From his collection of Mountain View items, a 7" by 9" enlargement of the first high school, built in 1902 at El Camino and Calderon Avenue.

I REMEMBER—CIRCA 1940--By Yvette N. Polizzi

Regarding Railroad Crossing Arms: Five members of the Highway Elementary School PTA monitored and recorded ALL traffic coming and going on each of the streets converging on the railroad track crossing. After many days of monitoring and MANY contacts with the railroad executives, we WON traffic arms to make the crossing safer. I will always remember that experience! I was the current PTA President and one of the five monitors.

[Please share your memories with us. We would like to hear what you remember. Send your entries to: MVHA, P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042-0252.]

MEMBERSHIP REPORT: BY JUNE CASEY

A/S = Single Members	125	
A/F = Family Members	122	
LM = Life Members	120	
HM = Honored Members	2 = 369 TOTAL MEMBERS	

New A/S members: Mary De Lucchi, Togo Nishiura and Leah McGarrigle

ASSOCIATION OFFICERS AND EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE

President	Robert Weaver
Vice President	Vivian Schatz
Sergeant at Arms	Craig Holden
Secretary	Margaret Peterson
Treasurer	Pat Figueroa
Past President (not active)	Nick Galiotto
Editor	Trudi Tuban
Membership	June Casey
Programs & Publicity	Honor Spitz
Hospitality	Laura Brown
Memorials & Remembrances	Edna Thompson
Ways & Means	Hip Telmont
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification & Recording	Al Jehning

MVHA EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE MEETING, MARCH 26, 2008

An auditing committee is being selected; looking for a Treasurer ProTem to assist the Treasurer; noted recent donations; new members and updated addresses; update on the MV museum to be; motion passed for a storage container to store future donated artifacts; additional insurance and discussion on selling extra copies of Mountain View High School yearbooks that are in the History Room.

Mountain View

Historical

Association

EL CAMINO BELLS

BY

JOHN KOLSTAD

Sunday, 5/04/2008

ADOBE BUILDING

CORNER OF CENTRAL

ESPRESSWAY &

MOFFETT BLVD.

Membership: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

Aims: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP OR RENEWAL APPLICATION

NAME:
ADDRESS:

TELEPHONE:

TYPE: NEW_____ RENEWAL_____
Regular Member $10/year
Family Membership $15/year
Life Member $200.00
Make Check Payable to:
Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

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first class mail

